LENA VARGA-HOLM

Senior Data Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Data Engineer experienced in building and operating production data platforms and cloud data warehouses. Works across Python, SQL, Airflow, Snowflake, dbt and Kafka, with a focus on reliable ingestion, orchestration, data quality and warehouse performance. Has led platform improvements at scale, including streaming shipment events, CDC and warehouse transformation, and mentors engineers while supporting day-to-day data platform operations.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, SQL

Data platform and processing: Kafka, Kafka Connect, Debezium, Airflow, dbt, PySpark

Warehousing and cloud: Snowflake, AWS MSK, AWS EMR, S3, Redshift, Glue Data Catalog

Engineering and quality: Terraform, GitHub Actions, CI/CD, Great Expectations, pytest

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Data Engineer | Lukovac Freight Hub d.o.o. *2022–Present*

- Own ingestion and orchestration for the data platform across Airflow, Snowflake, dbt and Kafka.
- Participate in the data-platform on-call rotation, one week in six.
- Mentor two mid-level engineers and run data platform office hours.
- Reduced Snowflake spend from approximately $38,000/month to $24,000/month in 2024 through warehouse sizing, auto-suspend and removal of unused tables.
- Designed and built a shipment-event streaming pipeline processing around 30 million events per day, with end-to-end latency under two minutes at p95. Used partner webhooks, Kafka, Kafka Connect and Snowpipe Streaming; added dead-letter handling and replay tooling.
- Migrated approximately 300 stored procedures to dbt models with tests and documentation. Introduced incremental models and slim CI in GitHub Actions, reducing the nightly warehouse build from 5 hours 10 minutes to 1 hour 35 minutes and making lineage visible to analysts.
- Replaced hourly full-table extracts from the orders database with Debezium CDC into Kafka, reducing replica CPU during loads from approximately 70% to 25%.

Data Engineer | Kovalent Pay *2019–2022*

- Built PySpark batch jobs on AWS EMR and designed Redshift warehouse solutions.
- Implemented data quality checks using Great Expectations.
- Developed a transaction reconciliation engine matching bank settlement files against internal ledgers, reducing finance-team manual reconciliation from approximately three days to four hours per month-end.

EDUCATION

MSc in Computer Science | Northgate Technical University

Thesis: Incremental materialized views

CERTIFICATION

AWS Certified Data Engineer – Associate *May 2024*

OPEN-SOURCE AND COMMUNITY

- Contributed two merged pull requests to an open-source Airflow provider for a SaaS CRM API, fixing a pagination bug and adding tests (Python, pytest), 2023.
- Teach SQL for beginners at a local women-in-tech meetup, approximately four evenings per year since 2021.
- Presented “Data contracts without the hype” at a regional data meetup, 2024.